



## Cambridge IGCSE™

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## PHYSICS

0625/42

## Paper 4 Theory (Extended)

May/June 2025

**1 hour 15 minutes**

You must answer on the question paper.

No additional materials are needed.

## INSTRUCTIONS

- Answer **all** questions.
- Use a black or dark blue pen. You may use an HB pencil for any diagrams or graphs.
- Write your name, centre number and candidate number in the boxes at the top of the page.
- Write your answer to each question in the space provided.
- Do **not** use an erasable pen or correction fluid.
- Do **not** write on any bar codes.
- You may use a calculator.
- You should show all your working and use appropriate units.
- Take the weight of 1.0 kg to be 9.8 N (acceleration of free fall =  $9.8 \text{ m/s}^2$ ).

## INFORMATION

- The total mark for this paper is 80.
- The number of marks for each question or part question is shown in brackets [ ].

This document has **20** pages. Any blank pages are indicated.

1 Fig. 1.1 is a speed–time graph for an ice skater.

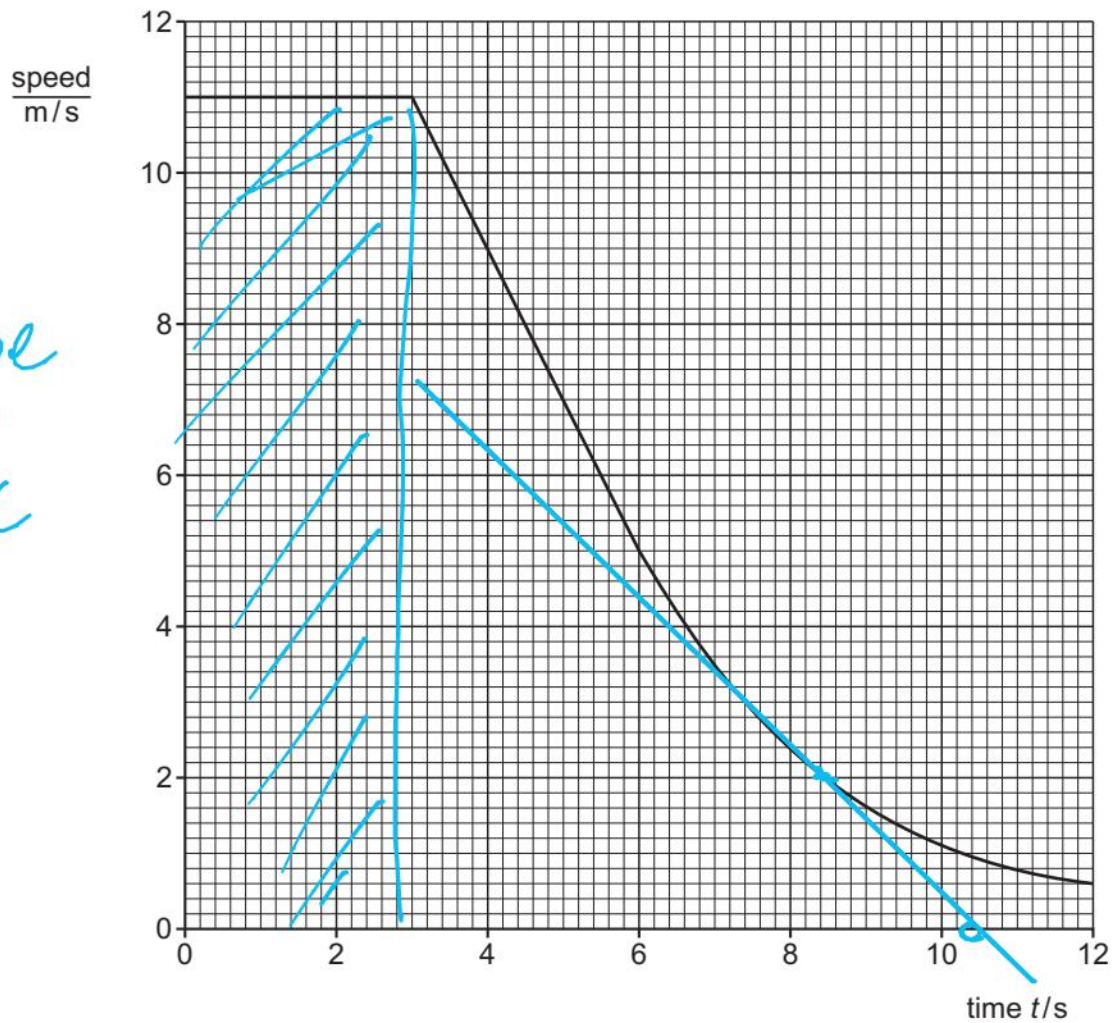


Fig. 1.1

- (a) Describe the motion of the skater between  $t = 0$  and  $t = 3.0$  s.

..... *Constant speed* ..... [1]

- (b) Calculate the distance travelled by the skater between  $t = 0$  and  $t = 3.0$  s.

$$L \times w$$

$$11 \times 3 = 33$$

distance = ..... *33 m* ..... [2]



- (c) (i) State what is meant by deceleration.

Rate of decrease in velocity [1]

- (ii) Draw a tangent to the graph at  $t = 9.0$  s.

Use the tangent to calculate the deceleration of the skater at  $t = 9.0$  s.

$(9, 2)$        $(14, 0)$

$$Acc = \frac{y_2 - y_1}{x_2 - x_1} = \frac{0 - 2}{14 - 9} = -\frac{2}{5} = -0.4$$

deceleration =  $0.4$  [3]

[Total: 7]

$0.50 \rightarrow 0.70$





2 Fig. 2.1 shows a balanced, uniform metre ruler made of wood.

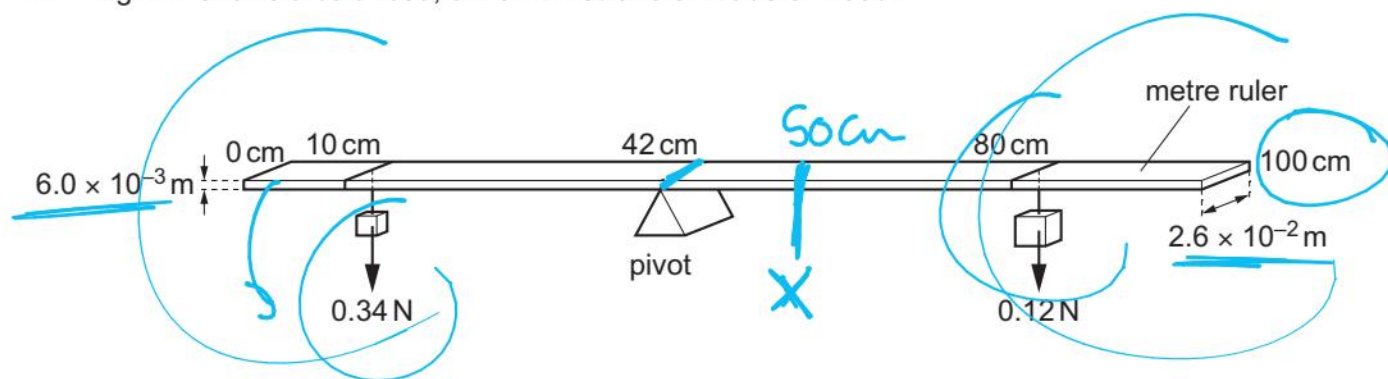


Fig. 2.1

The width of the metre ruler is  $2.6 \times 10^{-2} \text{ m}$  and the thickness of the ruler is  $6.0 \times 10^{-3} \text{ m}$ .

(a) Define the 'moment' of a force in words.

Force multiplied by perpendicular distance to pivot [1]

(b) On Fig. 2.1, mark the position of the centre of gravity of the metre ruler with a point labelled X. Label the distance of X from the 0 cm end of the ruler. [1]

(c) (i) Show that the mass of the metre ruler is 0.081 kg.

$$m = F \times L/D$$

$$Cw = acw$$

$$(F \times 8) + (0.12 \times 38) = (0.34 \times 32)$$

$$F = \frac{(0.34 \times 32) - (0.12 \times 38)}{8}$$

$$F = 0.79$$

$$W = mg$$

$$0.79 = m \times 9.8$$

$$m = 0.081 \text{ kg}$$

(ii) Calculate the density of the wood of the metre ruler.

$$\text{Density} = \frac{\text{Mass}}{\text{Volume}}$$

$$= \frac{0.081}{2.6 \times 10^{-2} \times 6 \times 10^{-3} \times 1}$$

$$\text{density} = \dots\dots\dots 520 \text{ kg/m}^3$$

[Total: 7]





3 (a) Define momentum.

..... mass  $\times$  velocity ..... [1]

(b) Fig. 3.1 shows two toy trains, A and B, on a track.



Fig. 3.1

The mass of train A is 0.45 kg and the mass of train B is 0.21 kg. The trains do **not** have motors.

Train A travels towards train B and they collide.

Immediately before the collision:

- the velocity of train A is 0.34 m/s to the right
- the velocity of train B is 0.12 m/s to the left.

The trains stick together when they collide.

Calculate the velocity of the trains immediately after the collision.

$$m_1 u_1 + m_2 u_2 = m_1 v_1 + m_2 v_2$$

$$(0.45 \times 0.34) + (0.21 \times -0.12) = (0.45 \times v) + (0.21 \times v)$$

$$0.153 + (-0.0252) = (0.45 + 0.21) v$$

$$0.1278 = v$$

$$(0.45 + 0.21) v = 0.1278$$

$$v = 0.19$$

velocity = 0.19 m/s

direction to right

[4]



(c) A different train is travelling with a momentum of 0.26 kg m/s.

The train slows down and stops after 2.1 s.

Calculate the average force acting on the train during this time.

$$\text{Impulse} = \frac{\text{force}}{\text{time}} \quad f = 0.12$$
$$\frac{0.26}{1} = \frac{f}{2.1}$$

average force = ..... 0.12 N [2]

[Total: 7]





- 4 (a) Fig. 4.1 shows two metal containers, A and B.

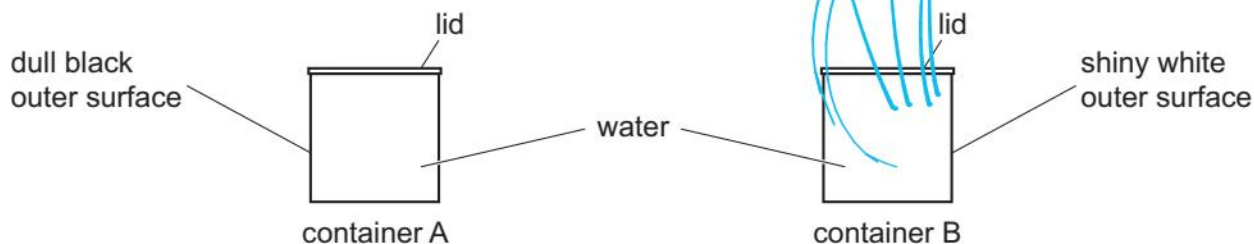


Fig. 4.1

Container A has a dull black outer surface and container B has a shiny white outer surface. A and B both contain very hot water at time = 0. The temperature of the water in each container is recorded every minute.

- (i) State which container has the larger temperature change over the first 5 minutes. Explain your answer.

Container A  
As it has dull black surface  
which are better emitter of heat [2]

- (ii) After 30 minutes, the temperature of the water in container A remains constant.

State, in terms of energy transfers, why the temperature remains constant.

Rate of transfer of energy from container  
equal rate of from to the container [1]

- (iii) The experiment is repeated without the lids on the containers.

State the name of the additional method of energy transfer that occurs.

Convection [1]





(b) Fig. 4.2 shows a metal pan with a wooden handle.

Metal  
 free  
 moving  
 e<sup>-</sup>

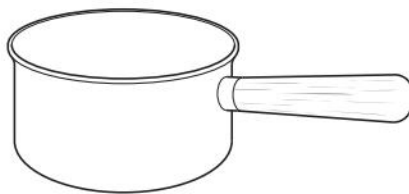


Fig. 4.2

wood  
 non metal  
 ↓  
 lattice  
 vib

Explain why there is a much greater rate of transfer of energy through the metal than through the wood.

lattice vibration &  
 electron transfer  
 2 ways

[3]

[Total: 7]



- 5 (a) Describe an experiment to determine the speed of sound in air.

State the apparatus required, the measurements taken and how to calculate the speed of sound in air from the measurements.

You may draw a **labelled** diagram as part of your answer.



Measure distance between 2 student using meter ruler, student (2) should start the stop-watch when he sees the light & stop the stop-watch when he hears the sound, calculate the speed using  $\text{distance} \div \text{time}$ . Repeat 5 times & take average. Assume time of seeing light is 0s [4]

- (b) Bluetooth is used to connect a mobile (cell) phone to headphones.

- (i) State the name of the region of the electromagnetic spectrum used by Bluetooth.

Radio Waves [1]

- (ii) State the speed of electromagnetic waves in air.

speed =  $3 \times 10^8 \text{ m/s}$  [1]





(iii) The frequency of a Bluetooth network is 2.48 GHz.

$\times 10^9$

Calculate the wavelength of the waves used in the Bluetooth network.

Page 8  
notes

$$\lambda = f \times 2$$

$$3 \times 10^8 = 2.48 \times 10^9 \times \lambda$$

$$\lambda = 0.12$$

wavelength = ..... 0.12 m ..... [3]

[Total: 9]



- 6 (a) Fig. 6.1 is a full-size diagram of a lens and an image I of an object.

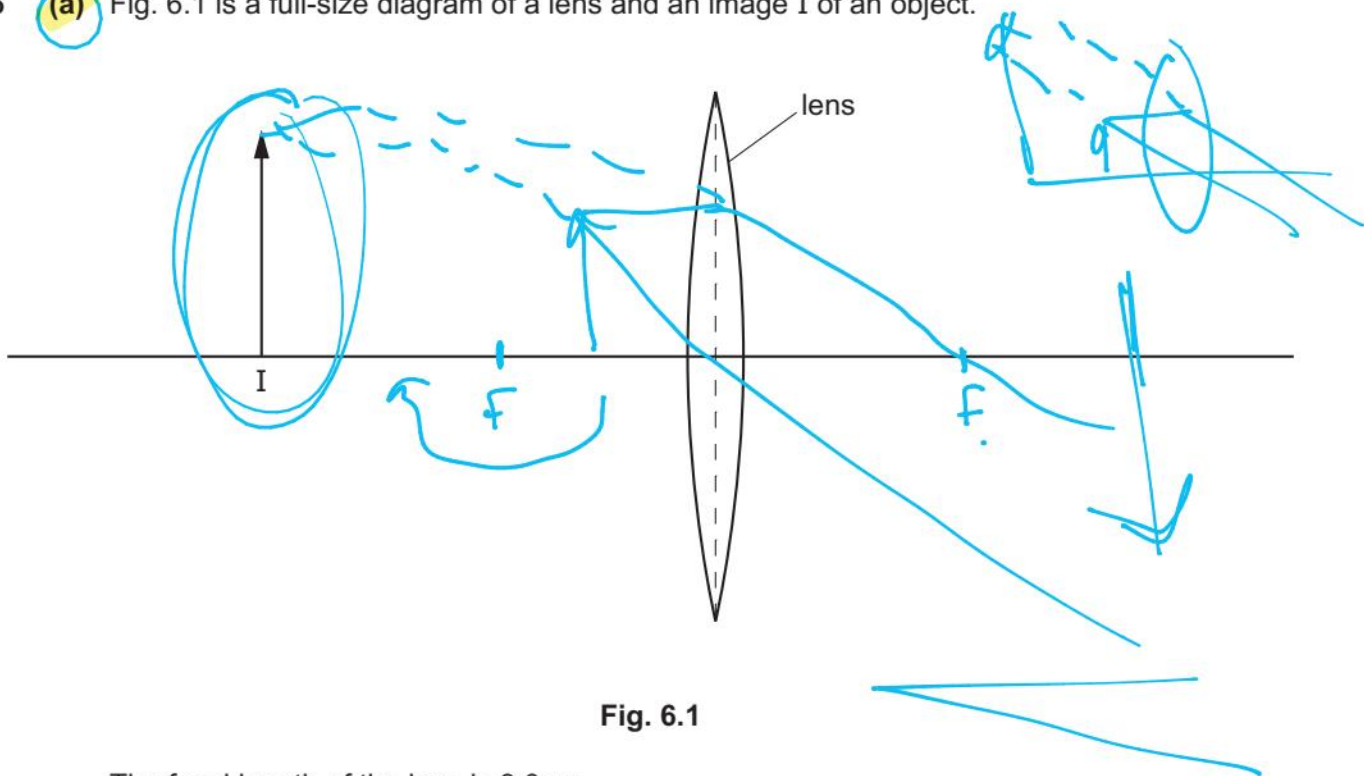


Fig. 6.1

The focal length of the lens is 3.0 cm.

- (i) On Fig. 6.1, mark **two** points with labels F, to show the positions of the principal focuses (focal points) of the lens. [1]
- (ii) On Fig. 6.1, draw **two** rays from the image I to locate the object. Draw the object and label it O. [3]
- (iii) The object is moved so that it is 6 cm to the left of the lens.

State one characteristic of the image formed when the object is in this position.

Real, Inverted [1]





- (b) Fig. 6.2 shows a simplified diagram of an eye with rays from a near object. The eye needs correction for long-sightedness.

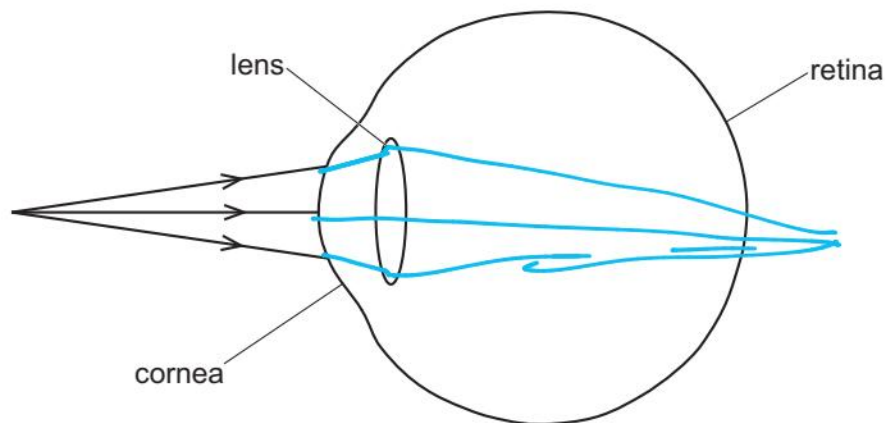
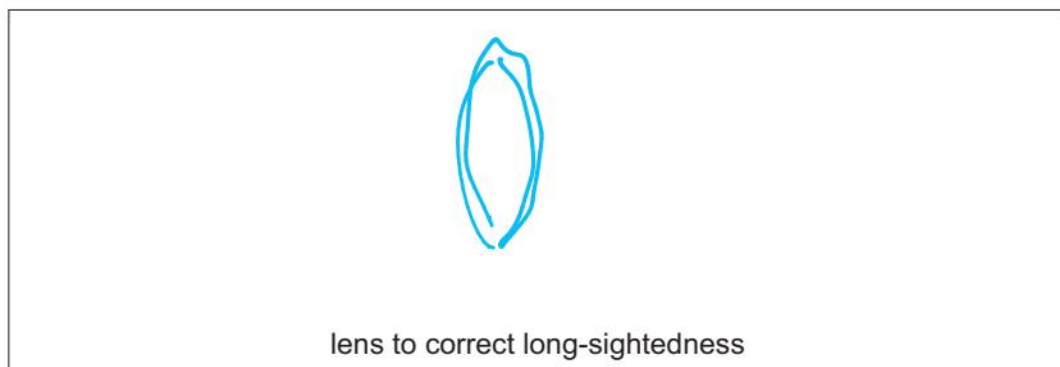


Fig. 6.2

- (i) On Fig. 6.2, draw the path of the rays inside the eye to show the effect of long-sightedness. [1]
- (ii) A lens is used to correct the long-sightedness.

Draw a lens suitable for this correction.



[1]

[Total: 7]



- 7 (a) State what is meant by an electric field.

Region where an electric charge experience force [1]

- (b) A plastic rod is rubbed with a cloth. The plastic rod becomes negatively charged and the cloth becomes positively charged.

- (i) Explain why.

Due to friction, cloth loses an electron, becoming +ve charged, while plastic rod gain  $e^-$  become -ve charge [2]

- (ii) The negatively charged plastic rod is suspended by an insulating thread. Another negatively charged plastic rod is brought close to the suspended rod.

State what happens to the suspended plastic rod.

move away as like charges repel [2]

- (c) (i) Define the kilowatt-hour (kWh) in words.

Energy transferred in one hour, at rate of 1 kilowatt [1]

- (ii) A small lamp illuminates an electric oven. The lamp has an output power of 25W and operates for 220 hours in one year. The p.d. across the lamp is 230 V.

1. Calculate the energy transferred by the lamp in one year. Give your answer in kWh.

$$E = P \times t$$

$$0.025 \times 220$$

$$\frac{25 \times 220}{1000}$$

energy = 5.5 kWh [2]

2. Calculate the current in the lamp.

$$P = V \times I$$

$$25 = 230 \times I$$

$$I = \frac{25}{230}$$

current = 0.11 A [2]

[Total: 10]



- 8 (a) Fig. 8.1 shows a simplified diagram of an a.c. generator.

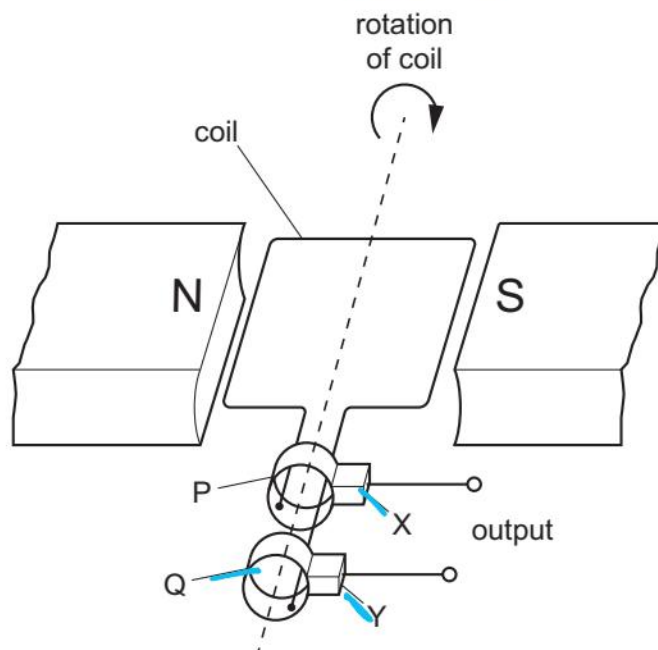


Fig. 8.1

- (i) State the names of components:

P and Q ..... *Slip - Rings* .....  
 X and Y. .... *brushes* ..... [2]

- (ii) Explain why an electromotive force (e.m.f.) is only induced when the coil is turning.

..... *Coil cuts the magnetic field* .....  
 ..... *perpendicularly when it turns* ..... [1]

- (iii) State **one** possible change that causes a larger e.m.f. to be induced.

..... *↑ nb of turns in coil* ..... [1]

*↑ speed of turning/rotation*  
*Stronger magnet*  
*↳ ↑ strength of M.F*





(b) Fig. 8.2 shows a circuit diagram.

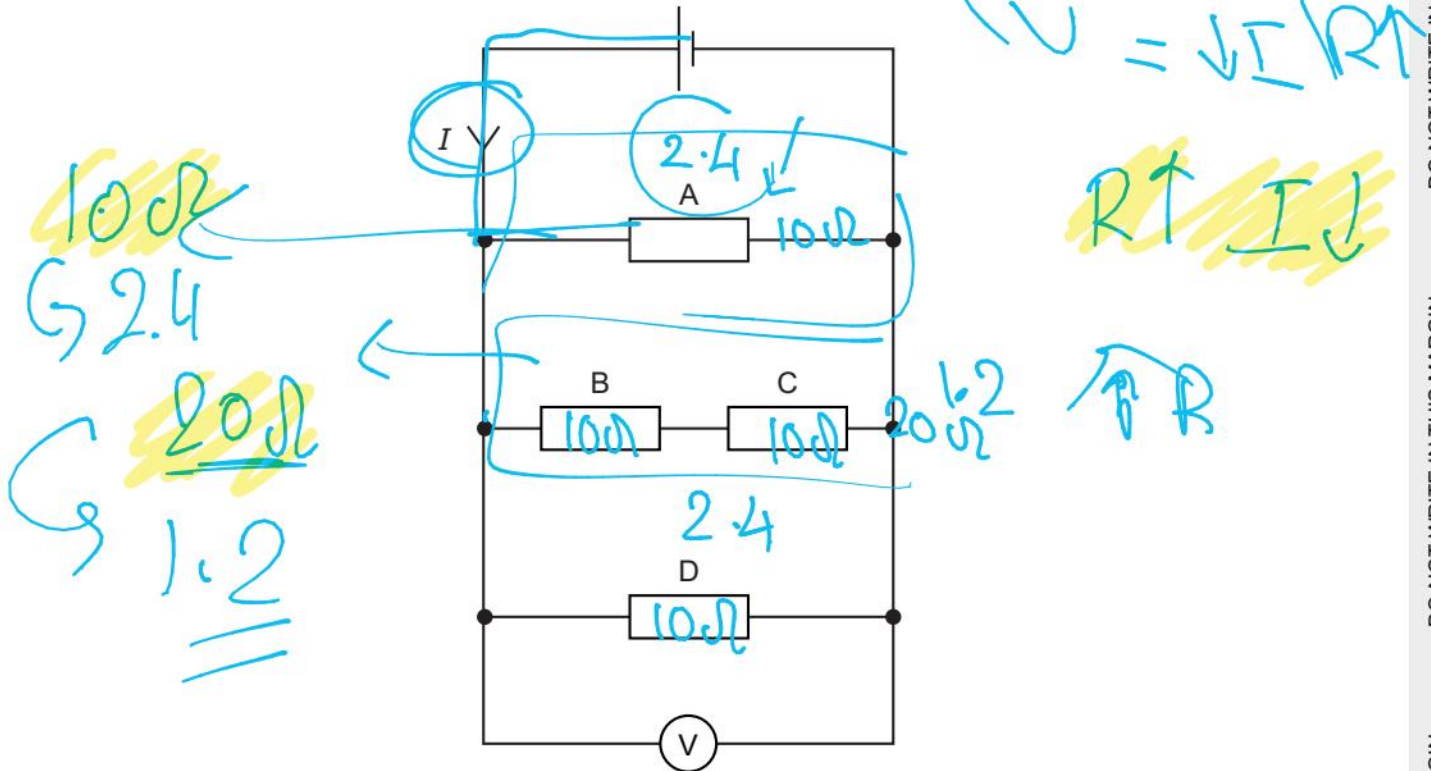


Fig. 8.2

Resistors A, B, C and D are identical. The current in resistor A is 2.4A.

- (i) State the value of the current in resistor B. Explain your answer.

current in resistor B ..... 1.2 A .....  
 explanation ..... Total resistance of two identical resistors are in series ..... [2]

- (ii) Calculate the value of the current  $I$ .

$$2.4 + 2.4 + 1.2$$

current  $I =$  ..... 6.0 A ..... [1]





(iii) The reading on the voltmeter is 5.0 V.

Calculate the resistance of resistor A.

$$\begin{aligned} V &= IR \\ 5 &= 2.4 \times R \end{aligned}$$

resistance = ..... 2.1  $\Omega$  [2]

       [Total: 9]



- 9 (a) (i) State what is meant by background radiation.

radiation / present in env / Radiation from natural resources [1]

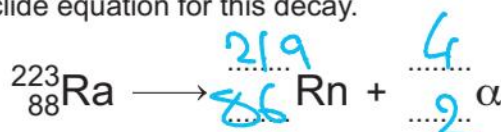
- (ii) State **one** source that makes a significant contribution to background radiation.

rocks / buildings / food [1]

- (b) Radioactive isotopes are used in some medical treatments.

Radium-223 ( $^{223}_{88}\text{Ra}$ ) is an isotope of radium. Radium-223 decays by the emission of alpha ( $\alpha$ ) particles to an isotope of radon (Rn).

- (i) Complete the nuclide equation for this decay.



[2]

- (ii) Radium-223 is injected into the body to treat a specific organ.

Explain why the source must be inside the body.

Alpha would be absorbed /  $\alpha$  will be stopped by skin [1]

- (c) An isotope of technetium is injected into the body to detect cancer in one of the organs. The half-life of this isotope is 6 hours and it decays by emitting gamma ( $\gamma$ ) radiation. The radiation is detected outside the body.

- (i) Explain why a source of gamma radiation is used.

gamma can penetrate skin needs to pass the body [1]

- (ii) Explain why a source with a short half-life must be used.

after few day / some time little radiation is emitted [1]

[Total: 7]



10 (a) Table 10.1 shows data for planets A, B, C and D.

Table 10.1

| planet | surface temperature<br>/K | diameter<br>/km | gravitational field strength<br>N/kg |
|--------|---------------------------|-----------------|--------------------------------------|
| A      | 153                       | 143 000         | 23.0                                 |
| B      | 623                       | 4800            | 3.7                                  |
| C      | 53                        | 50 000          | 11.0                                 |
| D      | 93                        | 120 000         | 9.0                                  |

(i) State and explain which one of these planets is closest to the Sun.

Planet B

highest temp

[2]

(ii) Calculate the surface temperature of planet D in °C.

$$93 - 273$$

surface temperature =  $-180$  °C [1]

(iii) An object falls through a height of 2 m on each of the planets in Table 10.1.

State and explain on which planet the object falls 2 m in the shortest time. Ignore any effect due to the atmosphere.

A, highest gravitational field strength

[2]



(b) Fig. 10.1 shows some of the stages in the life cycle of a massive star.

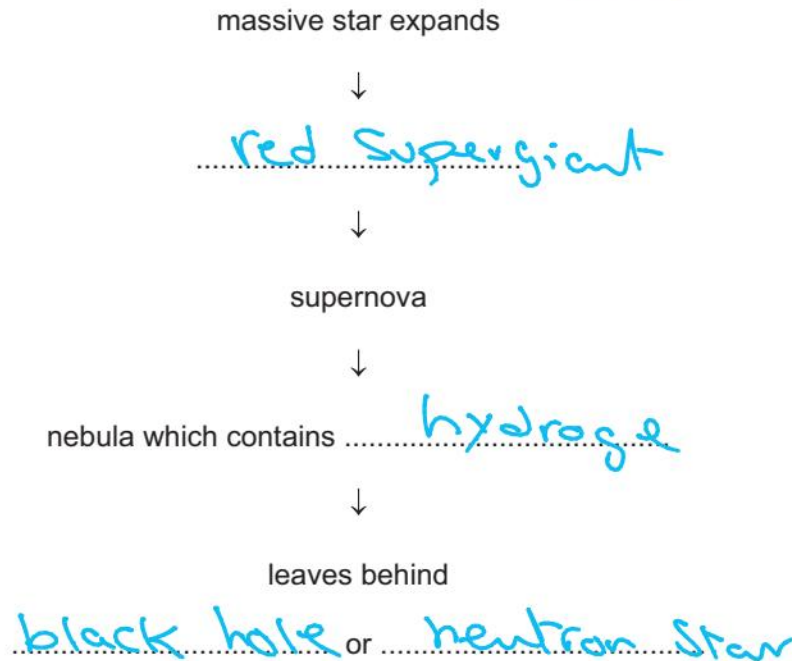


Fig. 10.1

(i) Complete Fig. 10.1 by adding the correct terms. [4]

(ii) State the quantity that the brightness of a supernova in a galaxy can be used to determine.

distance to galaxy [1]

[Total: 10]

★ distance to a distant galaxy  
↳ Brightness supernova

★ Velocity → Red-Shift

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